



Gameboy supercomputer for AI

A cluster of emulated Game Boys enables games to be run at high speed, speeding the training of AI. <https://digit.in/apr19-33>



Try Halo before launch

"Halo Inside Program" for fans to work with devs to improve new releases by testing them before launch. <https://digit.in/apr19-34>



The worst time to get a PC?

Agent001 is in two minds on whether he should upgrade his PC or not

Agent001 | agent001@digit.in

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he desktop PC has a special place in my heart and I've always loved this form-factor. Primarily due to

the amount of performance and flexibility that I get with desktop grade equipment. Which is why I frequently upgrade my hardware whenever there is a sizeable improvement in performance. I do own multiple computers but I only upgrade my main computer frequently while the others tend to get my attention once they start underperforming. Of late, I've been quite indecisive about upgrading. In the last one year, we've seen so many changes in terms of pricing, performance and general availability of products in India that I held out on upgrading for quite a bit.

There was the nasty cryptocurrency craze that had GPU prices skyrocket and simply become a nonsensical purchase. Both AMD and NVIDIA graphics cards were affected and that's not the only component affected by "market forces". DRAM prices were also all over the place. We heard quite a bit about supply issues at manufacturing facilities but a recent news item suggests that there was a price-fixing controversy involving some of the largest manufacturers for DRAM. The Chinese State Administration for Market Regulation

has supposedly uncovered massive evidence that Hynix, Samsung and Micron were involved in price manipulation. This wasn't the first time for some of the companies since a few months earlier, they were the subject of similar accusations in the US market. Over the last few months, RAM prices have plummeted overseas.

with each company leapfrogging over the other. With a launch set a few months apart, investing in a CPU that was bound to be overtaken in performance in just a few months doesn't seem like a wise decision. Obviously, this doesn't make the CPU one would have purchased a bad CPU just because another one knocked it



Perhaps these very manufacturers are self-correcting in an act of repentance or it could simply be the CPU shortage, the sad part is that RAM prices aren't dropping as quickly in India as they are overseas.

Then there's the performance aspect. We saw multiple back-to-back CPU launches from Intel and AMD

off the pedestal but coming from an enthusiast, it does matter. Simply put, you feel short changed no matter when you bought a processor. As for GPUs, there really isn't a choice since AMD has been releasing cards based on the same microarchitecture over and over again. There's a lot riding on their upcoming Navi GPUs which are